

ODI World Cup squad, has spent most of her time out of the India setup due to injury. She is a handy lower-order batter who can muscle the ball but, more importantly, rotate strike seamlessly, something the Indian tail often struggles to do.

### **Bleed for speed**

With Deepti Sharma's strike rate continuing to raise concerns, and the likes of Arundhati Reddy and Shreyanka Patil yet to impose themselves with the bat as consistently as India would like, Amanjot had the leadership's confidence. Her absence is a blow in itself, but what compounds it is her replacement, Kashvee Gautam, also falling out of contention after picking up a knee injury during the recent South Africa tour, one that now requires surgical intervention.

"In Kashvee's case, there is a problem in her right knee, and she will have to undergo an operation. It's a serious injury. Rest....," Amita began to explain, before the captain interjected, "About Kashvee, the medical team will update on her exact condition. She isn't available for selection."

The Indian setup is not known for prompt medical bulletins on player injuries, particularly those involving long-term issues. One instance comes to mind: when Shubha Satheesh fractured her thumb on day two of the one-off Test against England in Navi Mumbai, a medical bulletin confirming her unavailability was released only after India had sealed victory.

The bigger concern, though, is the failure to address a clearly worrying pattern. India's management of its pace-bowling pool has been far from ideal. Since 2023, several quicks identified through the Women's Premier League (WPL) have rotated in and out of the side. Shabnam Shakeel, with her forceful action, has also seen a dip in pace, an issue not isolated to her.

Beyond all this lies a larger question: where is Pooja Vastrakar, the quintessential pace-bowling

**Carving a niche:** This is a maiden international call-up for Nandni Sharma (L), who shone with her fast-bowling skills in the last WPL, where she represented runner-up Delhi Capitals. PTI

